



THE WHARTON SCHOOL

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT WHARTON

Wharton Business School is part of the elite “HSW” trinity. The entrepreneurial community has surged in the past six years, and the construction of a six-story entrepreneurial hub, Tangen Hall, offers further evidence of the ways Wharton continues to evolve beyond its roots in finance and drive entrepreneurial innovation. The business school’s success in incubating industry disruptors prompted Inc. magazine to dub the school “the spiritual center of the DTC startup movement.”

Women have made up at least 40% of the class for the last seven years. And its newly appointed dean, Erika James, will be first woman and person of color in its storied history. The quality of admitted students is also on the rise, if measured by the average 730 GMAT score of the incoming class.

The introduction of a Team Based Discussion component to the MBA admissions has been well received by participants, and showcases the interaction and inclusive values that are a far cry from the outdated stereotype of a competitive student body. The school's improving yield indicates that that more applicants are saying ‘yes’ to Wharton.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

General Management, Finance, Health Care, Entrepreneurship, Real Estate, Nonprofit/Social Responsibility, International Management, Economics, Big Data. Over 200 electives on offer.

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	2	2	6	6	*
Financial Times	3	3	4	2	*
Forbes	1	-	5	-	-
The Economist	4	4	5	-	*
US News	1	3	1	1	2

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	7158	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	916	Avg GMAT	722
Admissions Selectivity	23.10%	Avg GPA	3.6
Yield	55.4%	International	19%
Total Tuition	US\$160,864	Women	41%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Financial Services	36.2%
Consulting	24.5%
Technology	16.2%
Healthcare	6.7%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Accenture, McKinsey, BCG, Bain& Co., BAML, Blackstone Group, Credit Suisse, Facebook, Deloitte, Doordash, Amazon, Apple, Goldman Sachs, Google, IBM, Morgan Stanley, Nike, Kearney, TikTok, Pepsico, Paypal

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$150,000

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 93.5%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR WHARTON APPLICATION

BY DR. JUDITH SILVERMAN HODARA

Judith served as a core member of admissions committees at the University of Pennsylvania for almost two decades, most recently as Acting Director at the Wharton School's MBA Program. She was also an Associate Director in the Office of Undergraduate Admissions at the University of Pennsylvania.



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1

DEMONSTRATE YOUR TEAM ORIENTATION

One of the common stereotypes is that Wharton is an “eat or be eaten” kind of environment. Contrary to popular belief, uber-competitive Wharton is actually home to an extremely collaborative and team-oriented learning environment. The utilization of learning clusters, cohorts, and teams (you may work with 15+ over your time in the program) provide a platform for collaboration and learning to lead through teamwork. Accordingly, your application needs to reflect your ability to actively contribute and thrive in these settings. Individuals who present themselves as lacking a team-orientation or having a leadership style that is closed, rather than facilitative, will be at a disadvantage in terms of being invited to interview and ultimately being granted admission.

BALANCE YOUR PERSONAL & PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

2

Wharton does look at each applicant file holistically understanding that what you do for a living is not who you are or what you will bring to the community. You certainly would not want someone to consider you only by your profession, so it's a good idea to use some balance within the framework of your application. Your essay examples should reflect things that the committee may not know about you from outside the workplace, in addition to showcasing your professional skills. If you can keep in mind that you are a sum of about 10,000 parts, and show that in the application, the admissions officers will see that passion and connection too.

3

CONVEY YOUR INTEREST IN WHARTON

Choosing to focus on a particular field of interest in your application is key. Of course, applicants have a variety of interests that they intend to pursue during their MBA. However, in the application it may not be a good idea to be a generalist. Therefore you may want to speak specifically about a professor or a class or a club that interests you, and have them all be connected, so that there is a theme to your writing. With 200 other electives and an incredibly rich student life there are any number of ways to immerse yourself in the MBA experience so think about how you can contribute and make a difference.

ADCOM'S VIEW OF NON-TRADITIONAL BACKGROUNDS

4

Wharton actively encourages applicants coming from non-traditional backgrounds to apply to the school. In addition to bringing a wealth of diversity to the classroom discussion from an industry perspective, applicants from this sector have often also had non-business undergraduate academic interests. This combination helps to add to the energy of the classroom and club interactions. With the breadth of the University of Pennsylvania's graduate programs, where students can take up to 4 classes outside of the Wharton program and receive credit, it is not surprising that many Wharton students take classes in other related fields that would further their career paths in non-profit work, such as at the School of Education or School of Social Policy and Practice.

5

PRESENT YOUR CAREER PLAN

It's important within the context of the application process to show that you have a career path in mind. Students who indicate that they have "so many ideas that they don't know where to start" come across as unfocused and non-directed.

The Wharton Vice Dean once famously said, "If we only granted diplomas to those of you who had followed your suggested career paths from your applications, no one would actually graduate!" The beauty of a transformational business school education is that it gives you tremendous exposure to possibilities on a professional and personal level. However, Wharton admissions officers want to ensure that you can create a viable path to follow and that you enter the program with a sense of purpose. Business school has been likened to drinking water from a fire-hose, and those who come in with no plan at all are frequently hosed down by the blast. It is advisable to give as much detail as you can about next steps in your career, showcasing that you understand what the Wharton program will allow you to do along the way.

For more insider insights into Wharton please visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW INVITATIONS	FINAL DECISIONS
Round 1	08 September 2021	27 October 2021	15 December 2021
Round 2	05 January 2022	14 February 2022	23 March 2022
Round 3	30 March 2022	14 April 2022	10 May 2022
Deferred Admissions	27 April 2022	24 May 2022	28 June 2022



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

